

STAAR Bootcamp: staar-power

STAAR Power — Quick-Start Overview

Welcome, Hero!

You’ve downloaded **STAAR Power** — a superhero-themed STAAR prep week. Your students are heroes-in-training, you’re the Hero Academy Director, and STAAR is the ultimate villain they must defeat.

What’s in This Package

File	What It Is
LESSON-PLANS.md	5-day “Hero Training” lesson plans
ACTIVITIES.md	10+ themed activities including villain battle review games
DECORATIONS.md	Classroom decoration guide (Hero HQ setup) + hallway banner
STUDENT-MATERIALS.md	Hero ID cards, power-up tickets, certificates
PARENT-LETTER.md	Family communication template

The Theme at a Glance

- **Students are:** Heroes-in-training
- **Teacher is:** Hero Academy Director / Senior Hero
- **Each day is:** A training session to unlock a new “power”
- **Completing work earns:** Power-Up Tickets

- **STAAR test is:** The ultimate villain to defeat
- **Classroom becomes:** Hero Headquarters (Hero HQ)



Week Overview

Day	Training	Focus
Monday	Power of Reading	ELA — unlock the power to understand any text
Tuesday	Power of Numbers	Math — calculating your way through any challenge
Wednesday	Power of Knowledge	Science/SS — knowing things others don't
Thursday	Power of Focus	Mixed practice under test conditions
Friday	Power of Confidence	Strategies, celebration, hero graduation



Quick Setup

1. Print Hero ID cards and Power-Up tickets
2. Set up your door sign (“HERO HQ”) and a few motivational posters
3. Read the 5-day lesson plans
4. Send the parent letter
5. Run the week — it’s that simple!

Standard theme = less decoration, same great content. Focus your energy on the activities and student engagement.

Every hero starts as a student. Time to train. ✨



STAAR Power — 5-Day Lesson Plans

Hero Academy Director’s Guide

Daily Schedule Template

Time Block	Duration	Activity
Hero Assembly	10 min	Daily power introduction, motivation
Training Session 1	45 min	Guided review
Power Recharge	5 min	Brain break
Training Session 2	40 min	Independent practice (“Villain Battle”)
Hero Debrief	10 min	Review, award Power-Ups



MONDAY — Power of Reading

Theme: “Every hero needs the power to understand messages, decode clues, and comprehend information. Today you unlock the Power of Reading.”

Hero Assembly (10 min)

“Heroes! Welcome to Hero Academy. I’m Director [Name], and this week you’ll train to unlock 5 incredible powers. These powers will help you defeat the ultimate villain: the STAAR test. But here’s the secret — you already HAVE these powers

*inside you. This week, we activate them. Today's power: **READING**. The ability to understand ANY text thrown at you. Let's train!"*

- Hand out **Hero ID Cards**
- Explain the **Power-Up Ticket** system (earn tickets for effort, use for small rewards)
- Show the "Villain Board" — a poster listing the "villains" (skill areas) students will battle this week

Training Session 1 (45 min)

1. **(10 min) "Power Scan"** — 5 reading questions on whiteboards. Quick warm-up.
2. **(20 min) "Hero Training: X-Ray Vision"** — Teacher models reading strategies. "X-Ray Vision lets you see THROUGH the text to find hidden meaning. Watch me..." Demonstrate close reading, inference, finding evidence.
3. **(15 min) "Sidekick Practice"** — Partners work through a passage. One reads, one finds evidence. "Every hero needs a sidekick!"

Power Recharge (5 min)

- "Hero Pose" — students strike their best superhero pose for 30 seconds. Research shows power poses boost confidence! Play epic music.

Training Session 2: Villain Battle (40 min)

"Villain: The Confusing Passage" — Reading Packet - STAAR-format reading questions - Frame: "This villain tries to confuse you with tricky texts. Use your Power of Reading to defeat it!" - Early finishers: "Bonus Villain" challenge

Differentiation: - Struggling: "Training Wheels" version — shorter text, guided questions - **Advanced:** "Elite Hero" — complex passages, analytical response - **ELL:** Visual vocabulary, bilingual glossary

Hero Debrief (10 min)

- Review tricky questions: "The villain almost got us there, but here's how to beat it..."
- Award **Power-Up Tickets** (1-2 per student who completed the battle)

- **Hero Tip #1:** Post on wall — “Always go back to the text for evidence!”

TUESDAY — Power of Numbers

Theme: “Numbers are the language of the universe. Today you unlock the Power of Numbers — the ability to solve any mathematical challenge.”

Hero Assembly (10 min)

“Heroes, yesterday you unlocked the Power of Reading. Today: the Power of NUMBERS. Think about it — every superhero uses math. Calculating distances, timing their moves, measuring strength. Without numbers, heroes would crash into buildings. Today’s training: mathematical precision.”

Training Session 1 (45 min)

1. **(10 min) “Speed Force”** — Timed computation. “How fast can you calculate?”
2. **(20 min) “Hero Training: Problem-Solving Vision”** — Teacher models word problems step-by-step. “Every word problem is a villain in disguise. First, figure out what it’s REALLY asking...”
3. **(15 min) “Dynamic Duo”** — Partner math: one solves, one checks. Switch.

Power Recharge (5 min)

- “Super Speed” — 30 seconds of running in place, 30 seconds of silence. Reset.

Training Session 2: Villain Battle (40 min)

“Villain: The Trick Question” — Math Packet - STAAR-format math problems - “This villain hides extra information in word problems to confuse you!”

Hero Debrief (10 min)

- **Hero Tip #2:** “Always show your work — heroes don’t skip steps!”

- Power-Up Tickets awarded

WEDNESDAY — Power of Knowledge

Theme: “The smartest heroes know science and history. Knowledge is the most versatile superpower.”

Hero Assembly (10 min)

“What makes a hero truly powerful isn’t just strength — it’s KNOWLEDGE. Knowing how the world works. Knowing history so you don’t repeat mistakes. Today’s power: KNOWLEDGE. Science and social studies are your arsenal.”

Training Session 1 (45 min)

1. **(10 min) “Knowledge Scan”** — Rapid-fire science/SS questions
2. **(20 min) “Hero Stations”** — 4 stations around the room, each a different “power source” (science topic or SS era). Groups rotate, 5 min each.
3. **(15 min) “Villain Lineup”** — Match vocabulary terms to definitions in a timed relay. “Identify the villain before it attacks!”

Power Recharge (5 min)

- “Invisibility” — Everyone closes their eyes for 60 seconds of complete silence. “Heroes need to be able to focus in any situation.”

Training Session 2: Villain Battle (40 min)

“Villain: The Unknown” — Science/SS Packet - Mixed science and social studies questions - Midweek energy: keep it shorter (10-12 questions), leave time for a review game

(15 min) BONUS: “Villain Battle Royale” Review Game - Quick whole-class game (see ACTIVITIES.md — “Hero vs. Villain Showdown”)

Hero Debrief (10 min)

- **Hero Tip #3:** “When you don’t know an answer, eliminate what you DO know is wrong!”
- Power-Up Tickets + midweek treat

THURSDAY — Power of Focus

Theme: “The greatest power a hero has is FOCUS. The ability to concentrate under pressure.”

Hero Assembly (10 min)

“Today is the most important training day. Today you train your FOCUS. Any hero can be strong. Any hero can be fast. But the hero who can stay FOCUSED when things get tough? That’s the one who wins. Today we simulate the real battle. Test conditions. Show me your Power of Focus.”

Training Session 1: Simulation (45 min)

“Ultimate Villain: The STAAR Test” — Mini Practice Test - 20-30 mixed questions, test-like conditions - Silent, independent, timed - “This is the ultimate villain. You’ve trained for this.”

Power Recharge (5 min)

- Quiet stretch.

Training Session 2: Analysis (40 min)

1. **(15 min)** Review answers
2. **(10 min)** Self-assessment — students identify their strongest and weakest “powers”
3. **(15 min)** Small group “power boosts” — targeted review by need

Hero Debrief (10 min)

- **Hero Tip #4:** “Skip the hard questions and come back. A smart hero picks their battles.”
- Power-Up Tickets

FRIDAY — Power of Confidence

Theme: “Your final power — and the most important one. CONFIDENCE. Believing in yourself.”

Hero Assembly (10 min)

“Heroes. You’ve unlocked Reading, Numbers, Knowledge, and Focus. Today’s power is the one that ties them ALL together: CONFIDENCE. Confidence isn’t about knowing everything — it’s about trusting your training. You’ve TRAINED. You’re READY. Today we celebrate.”

Training Session 1 (45 min)

1. **(15 min)** Review top strategies (Hero’s Handbook)
2. **(15 min)** “Villain Trap Spotter” — identify common trick questions
3. **(15 min)** Fun review game (see ACTIVITIES.md)

Power Recharge (5 min)

- Hero pose + deep breathing. “Channel your power.”

Training Session 2: Celebration (40 min)

1. **(10 min)** “Letter to My Hero Self” — students write a letter to themselves
2. **(10 min)** **Hero Graduation Ceremony** — certificates awarded
3. **(10 min)** Students design their own “Hero Emblem” (draw their personal superhero logo representing their best skill)

4. (10 min) Celebration — music, treats, hero poses for photos

Final Debrief

- **Hero Tip #5:** “The power was inside you all along. You ARE a hero. Now go prove it on STAAR day.”
- All 5 Power-Ups = “STAAR Superhero” status 🌟

With great power comes great STAAR scores. 🌟

🌟 STAAR Power — Themed Activities

10 superhero-themed activities with 3 review games.

🎮 REVIEW GAMES

1. Hero vs. Villain Showdown (Whole Class)

Type: Class game | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Any subject

How to Play: - Project a question. Class is the “Hero.” The question is the “Villain.” - Students write answers on whiteboards. If the majority gets it right, the Hero wins. If not, the Villain wins. - Track on the board: Hero | Villain — tally marks for each - Play 10-15 rounds. “Can the heroes defeat more villains than not?” - Dramatic narration: “The villain attacks with... a MULTI-STEP WORD PROBLEM! Heroes, defend yourselves!”

Materials: Questions, whiteboards, markers, scoreboard

2. Power-Up Relay (Team Relay)

Type: Teams of 5-6 | **Time:** 15 min | **Best for:** Quick computation, vocabulary

How to Play: - Teams line up. First hero runs to the board, solves a question, runs back - Correct answer = earns a “power-up” (point) for the team - If wrong, next hero can attempt the same question - First team to collect 6 power-ups wins - “Speed AND accuracy — that’s what separates heroes from sidekicks!”

Materials: Question cards at the front, answer key, scoreboard

3. Villain Battle Cards (Partner Game)

Type: Partners | **Time:** 15-20 min | **Best for:** Vocabulary, facts, formulas

How to Play: - Create a deck of cards: front = question, back = answer - Also create “Villain Cards” (5-6 scattered in the deck) — these have trick questions or bonus challenges - Partners take turns drawing cards and answering - Correct = keep the card (1 point). Villain cards = must answer correctly for 3 points, wrong = lose 2 points - Most points after the deck is done wins

Materials: Card deck (index cards), answer key on backs



INDIVIDUAL ACTIVITIES

4. Hero ID Card Creation

Type: Individual | **Time:** 15 min | **Best for:** Monday warm-up, community building

Instructions: Students complete their Hero ID cards: - Hero Name (they create a superhero alter-ego) - Superpower (their strongest academic skill) - Weakness (the skill they’re working on) - Catchphrase (a motivational phrase they’ll use on test day) - Self-portrait in hero costume

Materials: Hero ID template, colored pencils

5. Hero’s Handbook (Personal Study Guide)

Type: Individual | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Synthesis

Instructions: Students create a small booklet (folded paper): - Page 1: “My Superpowers” (skills I’m confident in + strategies) - Page 2: “Villains I’ve Defeated” (skills I’ve mastered this week) - Page 3: “Training Still Needed” (areas to review) - Page 4: “My Game Plan for STAAR Day”

Materials: Paper, pencils

6. Villain Wanted Posters (Concept Review)

Type: Individual | **Time:** 15-20 min | **Best for:** Identifying common mistakes

Instructions: Students create “WANTED” posters for their worst test-taking villains: - Villain name: “The Rushing Robber” (not reading carefully) - Illustration - “Crimes:” what this villain makes you do wrong - “How to Defeat:” specific strategy - Post on a “Villain Wall” in the classroom

Materials: Paper, markers

PARTNER ACTIVITIES

7. Sidekick Swap (Partner Quiz)

Type: Partner | **Time:** 20 min

Instructions: Each student writes 5 questions. Swap with partner. Answer each other’s questions. Grade together. Discuss any disagreements using evidence. “A good sidekick challenges you to be better!”

Materials: Paper, pencils

8. Hero Training Montage (Timed Partner Drills)

Type: Partner | **Time:** 15 min

Instructions: Play epic music. Partners take turns doing rapid-fire practice: - 2 min: Partner A quizzes Partner B (flashcards) - 2 min: Switch - 2 min: Both solve problems

independently, compare - Repeat for 3 rounds - “Every hero training montage has a soundtrack!”

Materials: Flashcards or question strips, timer, epic music playlist

GROUP ACTIVITIES

9. Hero HQ Defense (Station Rotation)

Type: Groups of 4-5 | **Time:** 30 min | **Best for:** Mixed review

Stations: - **Shield Station** — Reading defense (comprehension questions) - **Laser Station** — Math precision (computation) - **Mind Station** — Science knowledge - **Time Station** — Timed challenges (speed round)

Groups rotate every 7 minutes. Record answers on a “Mission Log” sheet.

Materials: Station question sets, mission log sheets, timer

10. Avengers Assemble (Group Problem Solving)

Type: Groups of 4 | **Time:** 20 min

Instructions: Each group gets one complex, multi-part problem. Each member is assigned a “role”: - **The Brain** — Reads and interprets the problem - **The Calculator** — Handles all computation - **The Checker** — Verifies each step - **The Reporter** — Presents the solution to the class

All four must contribute. “A hero team is only as strong as its weakest link!”

Materials: Complex problems (1 per group), chart paper, markers



Activity Matrix

Activity	Best Day	Duration	Type
Hero vs. Villain Showdown	Wed or Fri	20 min	Class game
Power-Up Relay	Tue or Fri	15 min	Team game
Villain Battle Cards	Any	15-20 min	Partner game
Hero ID Card	Monday	15 min	Individual
Hero's Handbook	Wed or Fri	20 min	Individual
Villain Wanted Posters	Wed	15-20 min	Individual
Sidekick Swap	Tue or Thu	20 min	Partner
Training Montage	Any (warm-up)	15 min	Partner
HQ Defense Stations	Wed	30 min	Group rotation
Avengers Assemble	Thu	20 min	Group

Heroes don't just have power — they train for it. ✨

STAAR Power — Student Materials

Daily Overview

Day	Handouts	Rewards
Monday	Hero ID Card, Reading Villain Battle packet	Power-Up Tickets
Tuesday	Math Villain Battle packet	Power-Up Tickets
Wednesday	Science/SS Villain Battle packet	Power-Up Tickets + treat

Day	Handouts	Rewards
Thursday	Ultimate Villain Simulation test	Power-Up Tickets
Friday	Letter to Hero Self, Hero Emblem page	Certificate



Hero ID Card

Design: - Size: 3" x 4" (4 per page) - Header: “ ⚡ HERO ACADEMY ⚡ ” - Fields: - **Real Name:** [Student Name] - **Hero Name:** [Student creates] - **Superpower:** [Best academic skill] - **Weakness:** [Skill to improve] - **Catchphrase:** [Motivational phrase for test day] - Box for self-portrait as a hero - “Hero Academy Class of [Year]”



Power-Up Tickets

Description: Small reward tickets earned throughout the week. Can be collected and redeemed for small rewards (teacher’s choice: homework pass, first in line, small prize, etc.)

Design: - Size: 2" x 3" (print 10 per page) - “ ⚡ POWER-UP TICKET ⚡ ” - “Awarded to a hero for: _____” - Comic-book burst border

Award criteria: Effort on daily packets, participation, helping a teammate, exceptional focus.

Tip: Be generous. These cost nothing and motivate everything. Award 1-3 per student per day.



Daily Villain Battle Packets

Cover format: - “ ⚡ VILLAIN BATTLE: [Villain Name] ⚡ ” - Villain illustration/description - “Hero: _____ Date: _____” - “Power Level Required:

★★★☆☆ - STAAR-format questions inside (teacher provides content) - Back page reflection: “Villain Status: ☐ Defeated ☐ Needs Rematch”



Villain Wanted Posters

Template: - “WANTED” in large bold text at top - Box for student to draw the villain - “Villain Name:” _____ - “Crimes Against Students:” (what test mistake this represents) - “How to Defeat:” (strategy to overcome it) - “Reward for Capture: STAAR Success!”

Students create these on Wednesday. Display on a “Villain Wall.”



Hero Emblem (Friday Activity)

Template: - Shield/emblem shape outline - “Design your personal hero emblem. Include symbols that represent your strongest skills.” - Sections: “My Reading Symbol,” “My Math Symbol,” “My Secret Weapon” (test strategy) - Students color and decorate - Display alongside certificates



STAAR Superhero Certificate

Design: - 8.5x11 landscape - Header: Lightning bolt + “HERO ACADEMY” - Title: “STAAR SUPERHERO CERTIFICATE” - “This certifies that [**Hero Name / Real Name**] has completed Hero Academy training, unlocked all 5 powers, and is officially a STAAR Superhero. This hero is ready to defeat any test villain.” - “Director: [Teacher Name]” - Comic-book style border with POW/ZAP/BOOM graphics



Printing Summary

Material	Per Student	For 25 Students
Hero ID Card	0.25 pages	7 pages
Power-Up Tickets	~1 page/week	25 pages (pre-cut)
Battle Packets (5 days)	~3-5/day	75-125 pages
Wanted Poster template	1 page	25 pages
Hero Emblem	1 page	25 pages
Certificate	1 page	25 pages
TOTAL (ex. packets)		~110 pages + packets

Heroes are made, not born. These materials help make them. ✨

STAAR Power — Decoration Guide

Standard theme = focused on classroom. Simple, impactful, budget-friendly.

CLASSROOM: Hero HQ

Door Sign

- **“HERO HQ — Authorized Heroes Only”**
- Bold colors (red, blue, yellow), comic-book style burst/explosion graphics
- Print on 11x17 or 2 pages taped together

Hero Cape Door Hanger

- Cut a large cape shape from red bulletin board paper or fabric
- Tape above/around the door so it looks like the door is wearing a cape

- Simple, eye-catching, takes 10 minutes
- **Cost:** ~\$0-2 (use existing paper or \$1 fabric from Dollar Tree)

Wall Decorations

Villain Board

- Poster titled “VILLAINS TO DEFEAT THIS WEEK”
- List 5-6 “villains” (skill areas): “The Confusing Passage,” “The Trick Question,” “The Time Thief,” etc.
- Cross each one off (big red X) as the class “defeats” it during the week
- **Cost:** \$1 poster board

Power-Up Progress Tracker

- Simple chart: student names on the left, 5 columns (Mon–Fri)
- Add stickers/stamps as students earn Power-Ups
- Title: “HERO POWER LEVEL”
- **Cost:** \$1 poster board + stickers

Motivational Posters (Print 4-5)

- “With great power comes great STAAR scores.”
- “Heroes don’t give up. They power up.”
- “You don’t need a cape to be a hero. Just a pencil.”
- “Be the hero of your own STAAR story.”
- Comic-book burst style backgrounds (POW! ZAP! BOOM!)

Desk Name Tags

- “Hero [Name] — Power: [Student’s best subject]”
- Comic-book style border
- Print on colored cardstock, tent-fold

Room Arrangement

- Desk clusters = “Hero Teams” (name each team)
- Teacher desk = “Director’s Office”

HALLWAY: Simple Banner

Standard themes include a **single hallway banner** (no full transformation):

- “**STAAR POWER WEEK — HEROES IN TRAINING**”
 - Use butcher paper or tape individual printed letters
 - Add comic-book burst shapes around key words
 - Hang above classroom door or across hallway section
 - **Cost:** ~\$0-2
-

Printable Elements

Printable	Description	Size
Door Sign	“Hero HQ — Authorized Heroes Only” comic style	11x17
Hallway Banner	“STAAR POWER WEEK” block letters	Banner
Hero ID Cards	Name, hero name, power, weakness, portrait	3x4 (4/page)
Power-Up Tickets	Small tickets students earn and collect	2x3 (10/page)
Desk Name Tags	“Hero [Name]” comic style	Tent fold
Villain Board Header	“VILLAINS TO DEFEAT”	8.5x11
Villain Cards	Individual villain names with illustrations	5x7
Motivational Posters	4-5 hero-themed quotes	8.5x11

Printable	Description	Size
Hero Certificate	“STAAR Superhero” graduation certificate	8.5x11 landscape

Total Budget

Area	Cost
Cape (door)	\$0-2
Poster boards x2	\$2
Stickers	\$1-2
Cardstock for name tags	\$0-2
Banner supplies	\$0-2
TOTAL	\$3-10

Dollar Store List

- ☐ Red fabric or paper (cape) (\$1)
- ☐ Poster board x2 (\$2)
- ☐ Star stickers (\$1)
- ☐ Cardstock (\$1)
- Total: ~\$5**

Simple setup, maximum impact. The theme lives in the ENERGY, not just the decorations. ✨

STAAR Power — Parent Letter

English Version

[School Letterhead]

[Date]

Dear Families,

Next week is **STAAR Power Week** in our classroom! ✨ We're turning STAAR prep into a superhero-themed training experience where your child will unlock their academic "superpowers" and prepare to conquer the STAAR test.

When: [Monday, Date] – [Friday, Date]

What to expect: - 🦸 Daily "hero training" sessions reviewing key skills in [subjects] - 🦸 Students earn "Power-Up Tickets" for effort and participation - 🦸 A classroom transformed into "Hero HQ" - 🦸 Friday hero graduation ceremony with certificates

How to help at home: 1. **Good sleep** — Heroes need rest! 8-10 hours nightly 2. **Ask about training** — "What power did you unlock today?" 3. **Stay positive** — "You have superpowers. Trust your training!" 4. **Healthy breakfast** — Fuel for heroes

STAAR test day ([date]): Ensure your child arrives rested and on time. Remind them: "You're a hero. You've trained for this!"

Questions? Reach out anytime!

[Teacher Name] [Contact info]

Versión en Español

Estimadas familias,

¡La próxima semana es la **Semana STAAR Power** en nuestro salón! ✨ Estamos convirtiendo la preparación del STAAR en una experiencia temática de superhéroes donde su hijo(a) desbloqueará sus "superpoderes" académicos.

Cuándo: [Lunes, fecha] – [Viernes, fecha]

Cómo ayudar en casa: 1. **Buen descanso** — 8-10 horas cada noche 2. **Pregunte sobre su entrenamiento** — “¿Qué poder desbloqueaste hoy?” 3. **Sea positivo(a)** — “¡Tienes superpoderes. Confía en tu entrenamiento!” 4. **Desayuno saludable** — Combustible para héroes

[Nombre del maestro(a)] [Información de contacto]